

EXPLORE...

FREE



**The newsletter of the
Friends of Telford Town Park
Autumn 2013**

If you are a visitor to Telford Town Park, welcome to this Autumn 2013 edition of our free newsletter. We hope that this newsletter will inspire you to come along to the Park and explore it's many facets.

There is so much to see and do in Telford Town Park and nearly all of it is FREE!

We have the magnificent play area with its lake and water play feature along with the trim trail, spiders web and tunnel chute. Soon there will also be a crazy golf course and even sooner an aerial walkway and zip wire. There will be charges for this last item! The Friends voluntary group recently held 'Jolly Green Day' which was a day full of activities for people to get involved with out of doors. See the report on page 4.

If you would like to keep in touch with activities in the park we can add you to our emailing list if you wish. Simply contact us through our web site contact page with your details.

www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

The Friends of Telford Town Park are supported by Telford & Wrekin Council, Great Dawley Town Council, Madeley Town Council, Stirchley & Brookside Parish Council, Hollinswood & Randlay Parish Council and Lawley & Overdale Parish Council.

CONTACT

To contact or join the Friends (no membership fee) please use our web site above or leave your contact details with Reception in the Park Visitor Centre and we will get back to you as soon as we can.

Reception: 01952 - 382340



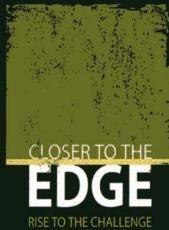
**We are extremely grateful to
Great Dawley Town Council
for sponsoring the
Friends 'Explore' newsletters**

Cover photo: Horse statue in the Chelsea Gardens

NEW ATTRACTIONS

HIGH ROPES COURSE TELFORD TOWN PARK

**adventure, fun and learning
for corporate, schools, individuals,
families.....everyone!!**



**coming
oct 13**



www.closetotheedge.co.uk 0845 880 2477

NEW WATER PLAY AREA NOW OPEN



Coming soon.....crazy golf course

JOLLY GREEN DAY REPORT SATURDAY 17 AUGUST

The day was a great success with around 1,000 people enjoying another free day out in Telford Town Park. There was so much for all ages to see and do, it was difficult to know where to start.

Probably one of the most popular attractions was the water zorbing, which for uninitiated involves getting inside a large plastic ball and going bombing off over some water for about 5 minutes. In this case Spout Pool was put to good use. I think the resident geese were a bit upset but they gave a wonderful flying display at the start of the day and another one at end the end when they returned! We also launched the 7th Telford Santa Fun run, see next page for details.



Telford's 7th Santa Fun Run

Sunday 8th December 2013

**10.30am The Visitor Centre
Telford Town Park**

To enter please complete a registration form, available
online from www.friendsoftelfordtoenpark.org or
from the Visitor Centre. £5 entry per person,
Adult accompanied children under 16 free.
Proceeds in aid of the **RNIB** and **Guide Dogs**.



Some sites to explore.....

Stirchley Chimney and furnaces:

If you walk on down past Wonderland, keep left and follow Randlay Pool on your right, you will eventually arrive at the Stirchley Chimney site. Originally Thomas Botfield built a blast furnace here and later the site was transformed into a brickworks. However no bricks were actually produced here. Go and have a look and learn more about the site, take a picnic if it's a nice day and sit and enjoy the wildlife there as well.

Stirchley & Dawley Railway platform:

Following the path past the Wonderland site, turn right keeping the Randlay Pool on your left now, after about 1 mile you will reach the old platform now restored. The path you have just walked along (Silkin Way) was the track of the old London and North Western Railway branch line to Coalport from Wellington. It ceased passenger traffic in 1952 and goods traffic in 1956.

The Queens Jubilee Monument:

If you walk up the hill next to Stirchley Chimney, you will arrive at the top and can then admire the Queens Jubilee monument erected for her golden jubilee in 2002. On top is a wind vane with the Friends logo on one side and a commemoration of Abraham Darby on the other. All around the column are tiles showing all the Commonwealth countries designed by local school children.

The Twin Tracks

On the west side of the monument leading down to a picnic area are the Twin Tracks. These were installed to commemorate the 250th anniversary of Thomas Telford's birth. They are set apart the exact width of a horse and carriage, as this was Thomas Telford's vision of how the potholed and rutted roads of Britain would be made of in the future. Thankfully, on this occasion he was wrong!



Work will soon be starting on the new pathways and signage around the park. This will be part of the ongoing Lottery Award that was received to improve and enhance the facilities in the park. There will also be 2 trails, one ecology based and the other heritage based. There will be leaflets available to assist you in finding your way around these trails which will take in all the important areas to see and learn about. The signage in particular will be welcome as currently there is very little indication of how to get anywhere in the park. Keep an eye out on our web site for further information as it becomes available.

DROP IN GARDENING SESSIONS

An excellent way to unwind in the fresh air is to pop along to one of our drop in gardening sessions.

We meet up every 1st & 3rd Wed of every month to do some light gardening and tidying up in the Chelsea Gardens. No experience necessary & all tools provided.

Even if you do want to do any work come along and see what we are up to in the gardens. A long term project is also a new sensory garden to be built. We are currently seeking the rest of the funding for it and then it will be all systems go!!! We plan on having a grand opening involving local sponsors, the RNIB and Guide Dogs UK.

We meet at the Visitor Centre in the Park at 10am on the 1st and 3rd Wed of every month and work until around 1pm, with a tea/coffee break mid morning! Do come along and join in the fun.





Don't forget
Wonderland when
visiting Telford
Town Park. Great
fun for children of
all ages.

USEFUL INFORMATION

Friends of Telford Town Park web site:
www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Reception visitor Centre: 01952 - 382340

Telford & Wrekin Council: 01952 - 380000

Cabinet member for leisure: Cllr Liz Clare

Park Manager: Nicola Allen

Chair FOTTP: Chris Pettman

WEST MERCIA POLICE (emergencies only) 999 or 112

WEST MERCIA POLICE all other incidents: 101

In the unlikely event that you see anything untoward whilst enjoying our beautiful park between 10am & 5pm, such as damage, rowdy behaviour, motorbikes etc., please report it to the Visitor Centre to inform the Park Rangers. At other times please call 101 and inform the Police.